LEAD DATA ENGINEER · CHIEF DATA OFFICE · QUILTER

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I lead data platforms on Databricks within Azure, and I work with the business as closely as with the code: every conversation with a department ends in a data contract that compiles into tests. London · firman.insan.m@gmail.com · right to work in the UK, no sponsorship required.

What I delivered at Lifepal, with how it was measured

6h → 90m
Nightly batch window. Median of 30 runs either side of the change.

99.7%
Less reporting latency: 24 h to under 5 min, on Kafka and Debezium CDC.

$11k
Monthly platform cost against a $19k projection, held for four quarters.

−60%
Ad-hoc report requests (214 → 86 a quarter); trust escalations fell by the same share.

512
Automated quality assertions across 47 sources in CI/CD. DQ ≥ 0.98.

The job description, what I've done, and a simulation you can run

THE ROLE ASKS FOR	WHAT I HAVE DONE	TRY IT
Technical leadership	Primary engineering authority across Finance, Actuarial, Marketing and Product. I lead design, review code and architecture, and record decisions as ADRs.	**Design review**
Engineering delivery	Batch and streaming on Databricks within Azure; Terraform, Azure DevOps and GitLab CI/CD; zero manual changes in production.	**Requirement to release**
Mentoring	Line manage 3–5 engineers; two promoted to senior; onboarding four weeks to two; 100+ engineers taught at Hacktiv8.	**Review a PR**
Cross-functional	Finance, Marketing, HR, Executive and Product own their definitions, agreed in writing before any code.	**Stakeholder week**
Operational excellence	Freshness SLOs with breach alerting, anomaly detection, and root-cause analysis that ends in a durable fix.	**On-call shift**
Regulatory	Masking, row-level access, lineage and retention for GDPR and audit. Consumer Duty outcomes as certified products.	**Consumer Duty**
Batch and real-time	Kafka and Debezium CDC into Delta with idempotent MERGE; batch for certified numbers.	**Streaming**

How I work with the business

- **No surprises.** Owners hear bad news from me first, in writing, with a time for the next update.
- **Start from the decision.** Point to a certified measure before building anything new.
- **Contract first, report second.** Definitions, owners, grants and tests live in YAML.
- **First Light under pressure.** Ship the smallest truth that helps today's decision, keep it reversible, name the debt, protect the team's focus.

My first 90 days

- **Days 1–30:** learn the domain from its owners and its data; build a record of what exists, what it feeds and who owns it. Change nothing.
- **Days 31–60:** own the highest-traffic products: run them, fix them, join their incident rota, and write contracts for the rules that live in someone's head.
- **Days 61–90:** agree one ingestion pattern, one quality mechanism and one deployment path with the other leads, adopted where each has proved itself twice.

Everything here is runnable. The simulations read the Delta tables my Databricks Python built, in the browser, with the same grants and masks: **rfim.github.io/nexus-quilter/simulate.html** · code: **github.com/rfim/nexus-quilter**

Depth, honestly. In production: Databricks within Azure, Delta on ADLS Gen2, Workflows, ADF, Key Vault, Spark tuning, Kafka and Debezium CDC. Unity Catalog, Asset Bundles and Lakeflow at working level; Data Vault and Fabric at concept level.